

Econ 623 Population Economics

Instructions for Research Paper

Before your next submission (second submission), your research question must be approved by Professor Rojas-Ampuero, if that is not the case, you will fail the second submission and will not have enough time to work on a new question for your final paper. Both 2nd and final submissions count for the final grade. Please follow the instructions below to write your research paper.

This is an applied economics paper, not an essay. An empirical econ paper is usually structured in the following way (all the papers we have read in class that are not literature reviews are structured this way).

Sections of the paper:

0. Title and abstract
1. Introduction. Includes motivation, question, a brief description of the methodology, data, results, literature review. The final paragraph should describe how the paper is structured.
2. Background: Context or history of the policy you are studying. Be efficient and include information that is relevant to answer your question, remember this is an economics paper, not a review of the policy.
3. Data and Empirical Methodology. Describe the data you are going to use, use tables and/or figures to summarize the most important variables of your analysis. Describe your empirical methodology. Be very clear about the variables that will enter your regression (if any) and their definitions. Cite your data properly and other papers if you are using their methodology.
4. Analysis. This can be split into several sections/subsections. It is up to you how you want to structure the analysis, but a general structure usually includes the main or baseline results, and then mechanisms. Some authors include a final subsection where they discuss the policy implications of their results (if any).
5. Conclusions. Brief summary of your results, why are they important, how are they important for policy. What are the limitations of your analysis?
6. References. Remember you need ECONOMICS papers.

For submission 2 you need at least sections 0, 1, 2, 3 and 6, and if you have results already include them, so I can better help you progress with your analysis. **Add a section** before the references where you describe your next steps before the final submission.

Final submission is the complete paper. The final paper is 12-15 pages long, double spaced, including figures, tables, and references.

Note 1: Figures and tables for the analysis should be included in the 12-15 pages.

Note 2: You can have an appendix section after page 15 to include anything you think is important, but it is not part of the main analysis.

Note 3: A good idea on how to write a paper is to choose an econ paper you really like and follow its structure. A paper I really like and has a very well written introduction is Chyn (2018). [“Moved to Opportunity: The Long-Run Effects of Public Housing Demolition on Children.” *American Economic Review*.](#)